

and is especially efficient. It detects the best setting for the video, so even if you set a very high encoding bitrate,

it will not go beyond what is required, giving you high quality and maintaining the file size optimally.

AUDIO EDITING

Covered here are some of the best software for digital audio creation and tips to help you get started and become more familiar with them



Cakewalk SONAR

This MIDI and digital audio software is used by professionals for producing CDs, soundtracks, live performances and Internet content. SONAR is the perfect avenue for enthusiasts to enter into the world of digital audio and MIDI-based recording

Templates

If you plan to use Cakewalk for your music projects, it makes sense to have a template ready to define your musical ensemble, say, a pop track or a jazz quartet or a particular studio configuration

(MIDI instruments, audio outputs, and so on). Templates make it fast and easy to create and configure new projects.

To create a template, create a new file. Add tracks, select the track properties and the instruments you want in your template. Now adjust the parameters and click **File > Save As** and select **Template** from the **Save as Type** list. Enter a name and click **Save**.

Layouts

You can save the current workspace layout (menus, panels, palettes, etc) or load

any saved layout and apply it to the current project. You might want to create a layout so you can easily arrange the items in a convenient size and position on the screen. This is also useful if you create different genres of music ranging from Jazz to Pop to Classical, where you would want different workspaces to be shown depending on what you are comfortable with.

Shortcuts

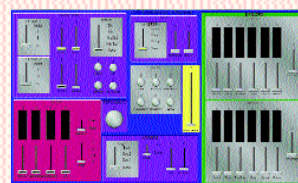
Learn the basic shortcuts. The [Spacebar] starts and stops playback and the [W] key takes you to the start of the track. Use key bindings to associate commands with keys on your MIDI or computer keyboard. You can bind a key sequence like [Ctrl] + [M] to drop markers, or [Ctrl] + [A] to stop recording and return to the beginning of the song and so on. Select **Options > Key Bindings** to display the Key Bindings dialog box. You can even map out keys on your MIDI keyboard to act as triggers for events. For example, if you want [C] + [4] on your keyboard to activate your graphic EQ, you can map it as such using key binding in SONAR.

Studiware panels

One of the most useful features introduced in the recent versions of Cakewalk is the implementation of Studiware panels. Simply put, Studiware panels are

onscreen representations of your outboard hardware such as FX units, mixers and so on. For example, if you have a Yamaha 03D, which is a 26-channel digital mixer, you can control its MIDI aspects onscreen through the use of a custom Studiware Panel that emulates its control panel. With a few simple mouse clicks you can control the device's faders, pan pots, effect sends and channel on/off functions through the graphic representation of its control panel.

There are always new panels available for download on the Cakewalk Web site. To open a new Studiware panel click **File > Open** and choose the file type as Studiware.



You can build your own front panels in SONAR

Undo and redo

Cakewalk supports up to 128 levels of Undo. Use the Undo and Redo functions in the Edit menu to step back and forth through recent edits. You can also jump directly to one of the previous 128 edits by selecting **Edit > History** and then selecting the edit point you'd like to return to.

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